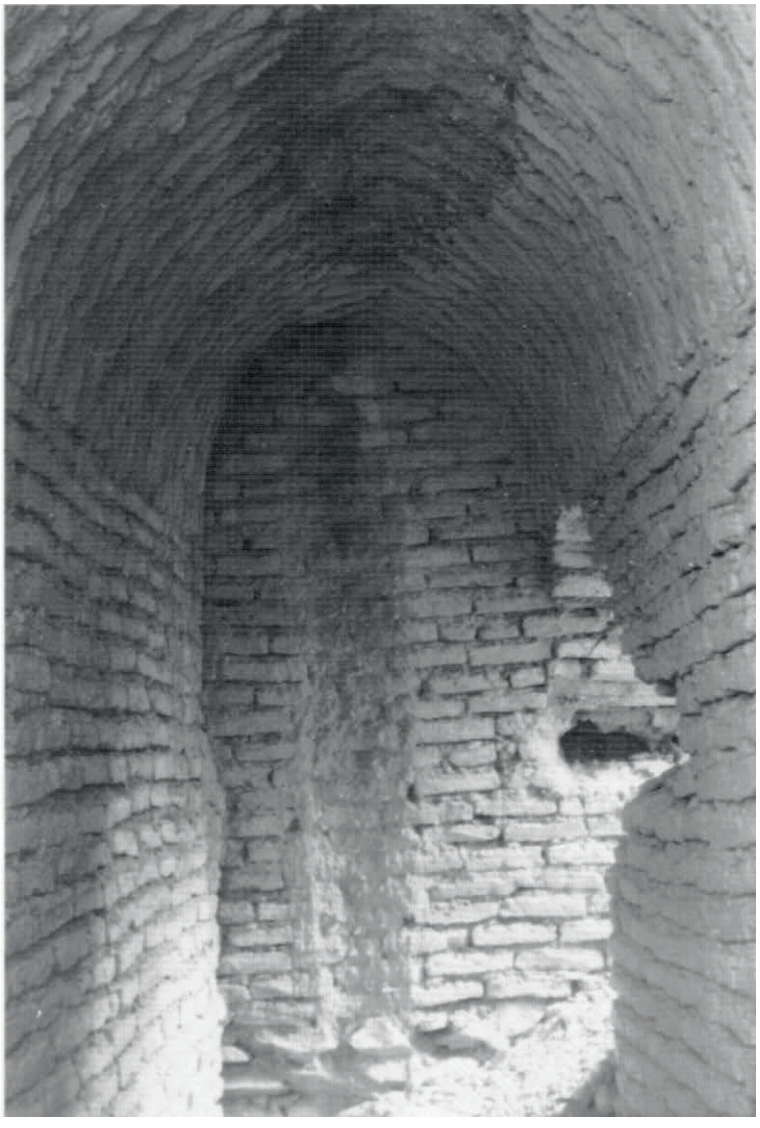


Figure 3.26 *Sarkhushak, Building A, vault. From Baker and Allchin 1996: fig. 5.17.*

tural milieu – defined in part by its centuries of cosmopolitan Buddhism – quite likely demanded a more sedentist court structure of the Bamiyan branch of Shansabanis. In light of their earlier exposure to settled lifestyles and economies, the Bamiyan lineage's transition to palace dwelling – also in reoccupied contexts, such as Shahr-i Ghulghula – appears more credible. Thereafter, in the course of consolidating and maintaining power, the Bamiyan Shansabanis appear to have reoccupied *and* commissioned new palatial complexes, not unlike their Ghaznavid predecessors.[81] In any case, the end result was that, despite their agnatic connections, the two